EVOLUTION OF COALITION SUPPORT FUNDS

Following the tragic events of September 11, 2001, Pakistan became a member of the coalition formed to eliminate Al Qaeda and the Taliban Government of Afghanistan. At the request of the U.S. during the early phases of Operation Enduring Freedom (OEF), Pakistan offered the use of its airspace, four airfields and a seaport, fuel, water, and other utilities at those locations, deployed large numbers of its armed forces to protect deployed U.S. personnel, and later permitted the establishment of air and ground lines of communication through Pakistan into Afghanistan. Today, much of the fuel and dry cargo required to support U.S. and NATO military operations in Afghanistan transit Pakistan, and because of our cooperative relationship with the Pakistani armed forces, we lose very little of the supplies to insurgent activity despite the close proximity of these lines of communication to Al Qaeda and Taliban safe havens.

At the request of the U.S. in 2001, Pakistan deployed its Army for the first time in history into the tribal agencies of the FATA along the border with Afghanistan to assist U.S. operations in Afghanistan by capturing Al Qaeda and Taliban fighters fleeing Tora Bora. Several hundred of these fighters were eventually captured and turned over to U.S. custody. For example, Pakistani forces captured Abu Zubayadah, a senior Al-Qaeda operative and Osama Bin Laden confidant. During a raid on a residence in Rawalpindi, Pakistani forces arrested Al-Qaeda senior leader Khalid Sheikh Mohammad, the alleged mastermind behind the September 11th attacks and wanted by the U.S. for his involvement in the 2002 murder of U.S. journalist Daniel Pearl.

Because Pakistan had only a limited capability to sustain such a high level of military activity in support of OEF, the United States decided it needed a mechanism to reimburse Pakistan and other cooperating nations for the support they were providing in the WOT. This program became known as Coalition Support Funds.

It is important not to confuse CSF with military assistance or development programs to Pakistan. CSF is not bilateral assistance and it is not intended as a mechanism to build capability or capacity in other nation's defense forces. It is an authority Congress granted to the Department of Defense (DoD) to reimburse Pakistan and other key cooperating nations for logistical, military, and other support they provide to the United States in support of the WOT. To date, the authority has been used to reimburse Pakistan and 26 other nations for contributions to U.S. military operations.

In 2002, Congress authorized and appropriated $390M in the FY2002 Emergency Supplemental "for payments to reimburse Pakistan, Jordan, and other key cooperating nations for logistical and military support provided to United States military operations in connection with the Global War on Terrorism." This program has been reauthorized and funds appropriated every year since FY2002. These payments are made only when the Secretary of Defense determines that documents provided to justify reimbursement requests "...adequately account for the support provided..." and upon concurrence of the Secretary of State and in consultation with the Office of Management and Budget. The DoD is required to report CSF reimbursements quarterly to the four Defense oversight committees and has regularly briefed these Committees, and to the House Oversight and Government Reform Subcommittee on National Security and Foreign Affairs, to answer questions and provide details related to the CSF program.

Copyright © 2010. Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated. All rights reserved.

Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,